WEBSITE PROPOSAL: REVIVE THRIFT CO.

Module: WEB DEVELOPMENT (WEDE5020)

Full Name: Lesedi Tsutsubi

Student Number: ST10519854

GROUP: 2



Table Of Contents:

Organisation Overview 3

Website Goals and Objectives 3

Current Website Analysis 4

Proposed Website Features and Functionality 4

Design and User Experience 5

Technical Requirements 8

Timeline and Milestones 8

Budget 9

Major Changes made to the website (Part 2) 10

Major Changes made to the website (Part 3: Final POE) 11

Final website against the proposal 14

References 15

ORGINASATION OVERVIEW: Revive Thrift Co.

Revive Thrift Co. is a newly established second-hand and vintage clothing store opening in Braamfontein, Johannesburg a student-heavy, fashionconscious area that previously hosted a well-loved thrift store before it closed permanently. Revive Thrift Co., was founded to fill that gap, offering affordable, quality preloved fashion to students and young professionals. Our mission is to make sustainable, individual style accessible and affordable; our vision is to become Braamfontein's go-to destination for unique, budget-friendly fashion. The target audience is students and young professionals aged 18 to 35 who want individuality without the cost of retail fashion.

Website Goals and Objectives:

- Build brand awareness for our new business entering a familiar retail space.
- Drive both foot traffic to the physical store and interest in an online catalogue.
- Grow a loyal customer community around sustainable, affordable fashion.
- KPIs: website visits that convert to store visits, catalogue enquiries, social media follower growth.

Current Website Analysis:

As a new business, Revive Thrift Co. has no existing website, which is itself a strength: the site can be built from scratch with modern UX rather than retrofitted. The gap it responds to is the previous nearby thrift store's reliance solely on Facebook, which led to outdated information and no browsable catalogue. Revive Thrift Co.'s website will avoid these gaps from the outset, but also major changes made to the whole website and a different user interface implemented with the same color gradients but a totally different look.

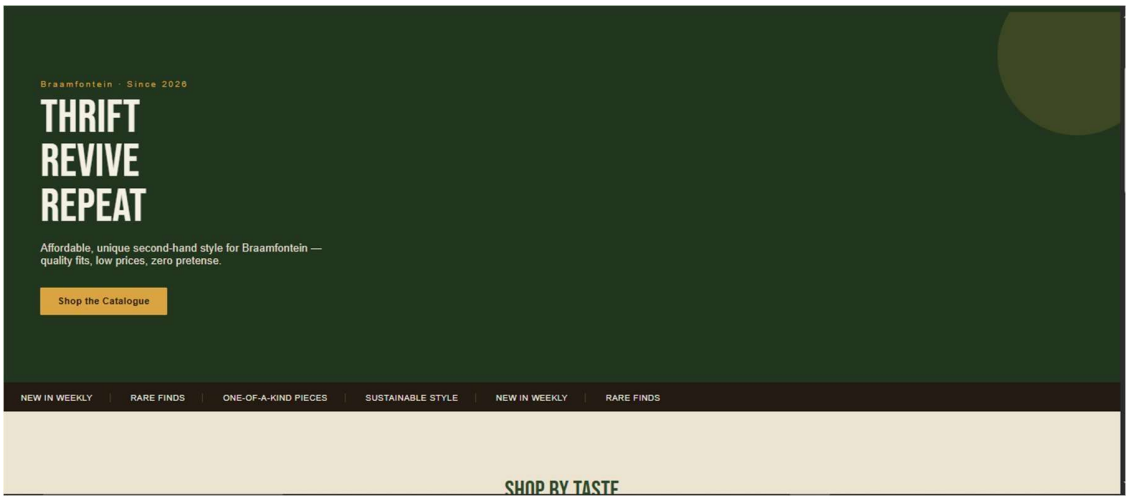
Proposed Website Features and Functionality

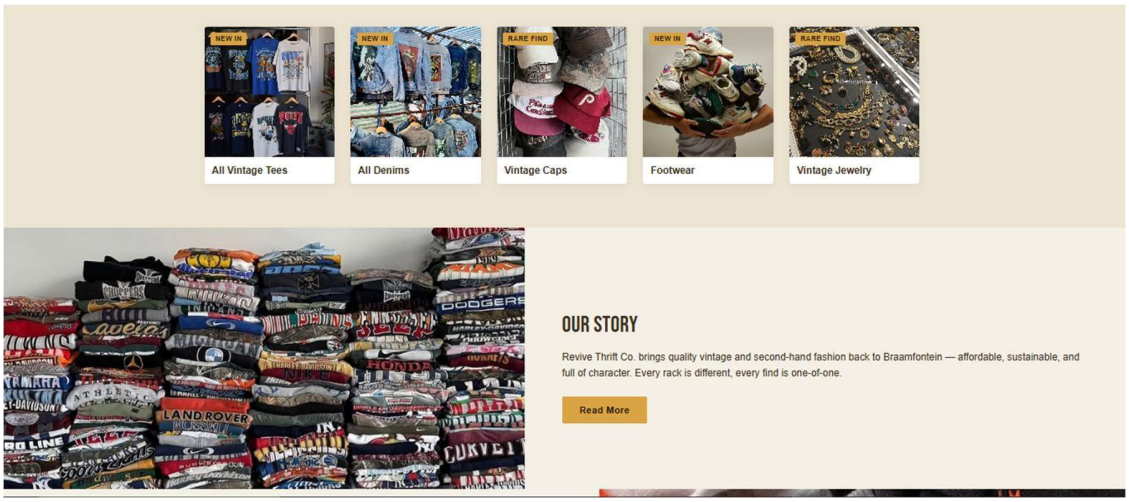
- Homepage introduces the store and includes a brief story but for additional information users can click about button at the navigation bar.
- Shop/Catalogue page browsable by category (All vintage tees, All Denim, Vintage caps, Footgear, and Vintage Jewelry.).
- Location & Hours page with an embedded map.
- Instagram feed integration to showcase new stock.
- Contact page with WhatsApp and email options.
- And “NEW IN” tags on the clothing category to show any new items or pieces that have been sourced out.
- Also, a cool function that was added when the user clicks the logo the website goes home instantly.

Design and User Experience:

- Color Scheme: earthy tones — mustard, forest green, and cream — to evoke vintage warmth, this will bring about a vintage classic theme.
- Typography: a retro-inspired display font for headings, paired with a clean sans-serif for body text.
- Layout and Design: grid-based catalogue layout with large, clear product images.
- User experience considerations: simple filtering and a mobile friendly layout, since most shoppers browse via phone.

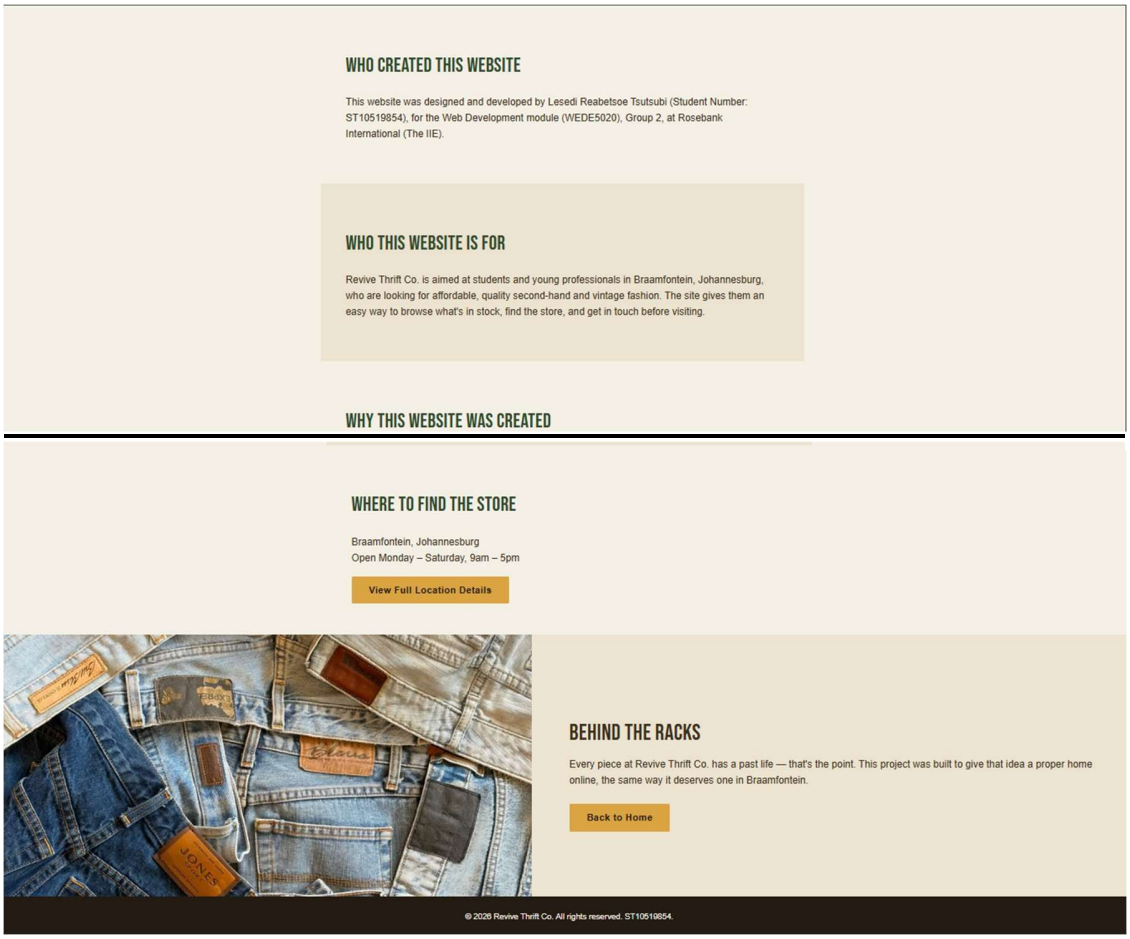
The homepage has been built to reflect this design direction, shown below:



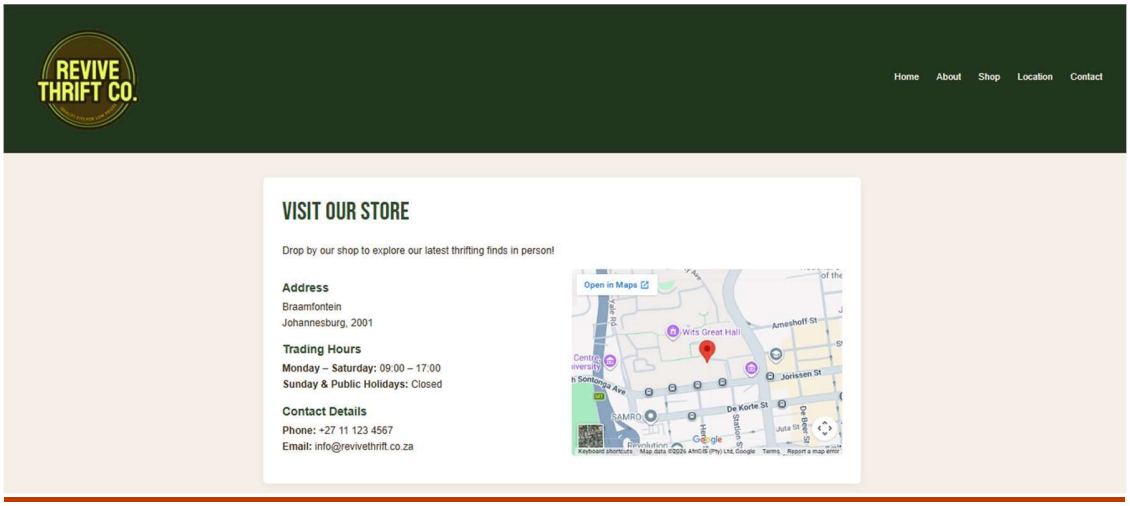


The about page:

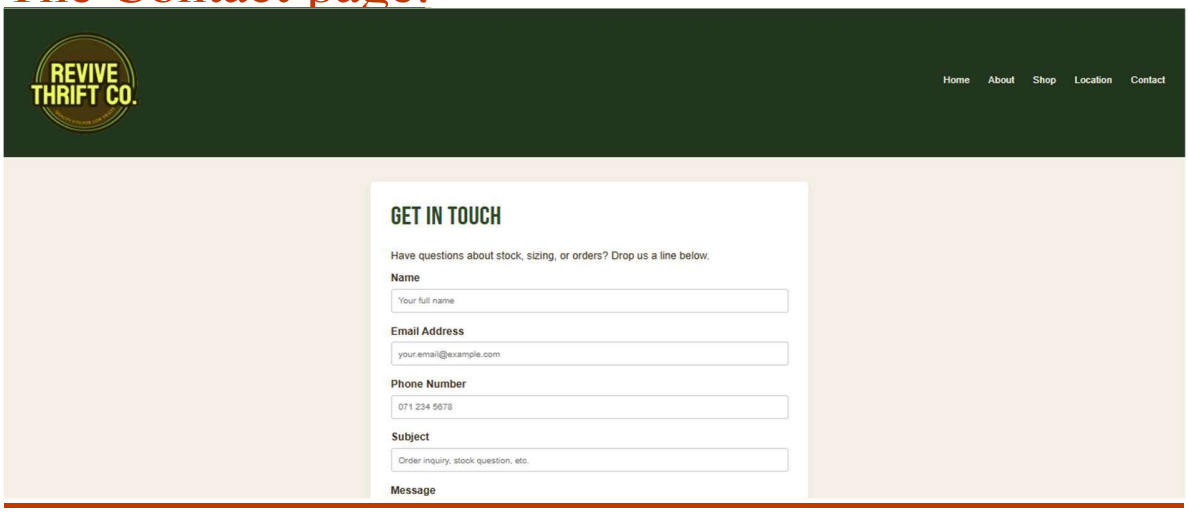




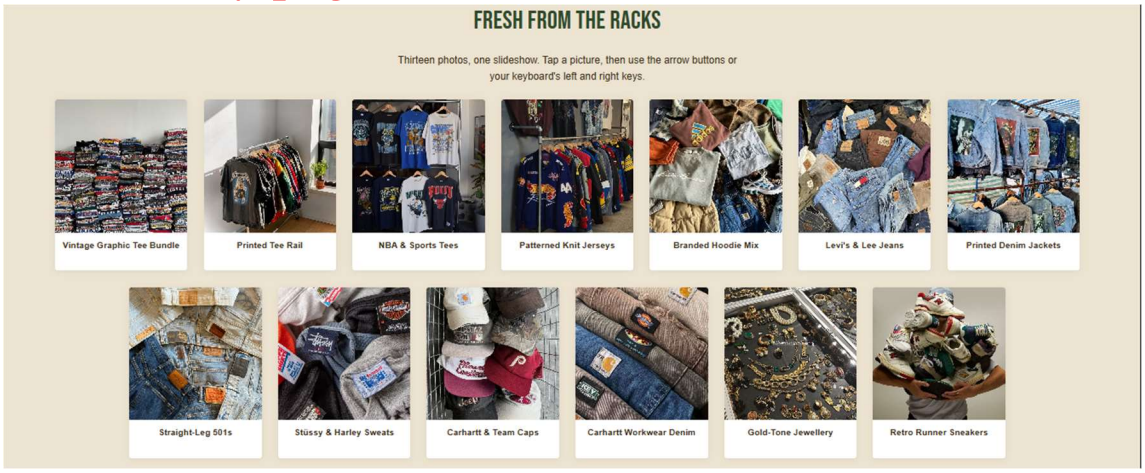
The location page:



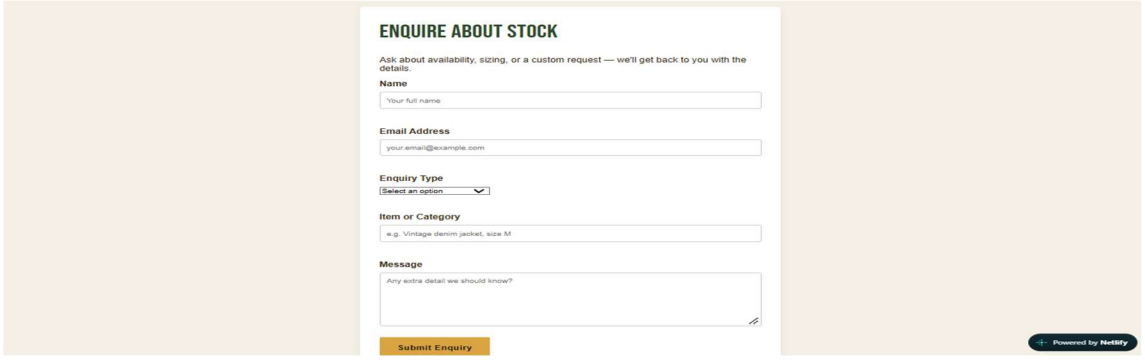
The Contact page:



The Gallery page:



The Enquiry page:



Technical Requirements:

- A. co.za domain (e.g. revivethrift.co.za) hosted through a provider such as Namecheap.
- The site will be built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- A code editor (preferably VS code or any code editor to the developers choosing).
- Must be tested on at least two browsers (Chrome + Microsoft Edge).
- Git + GitHub for version control, this lets developers track changes and is often expected for web development.
- Meta description tags per page
- Semantic HTML (header/nav/main/footer).
- Minified CSS/JS for submission for the website.

Timeline and Milestones:

- Weeks 1 till 2: Wireframes and design approval. Content and photo sourcing – gathering/editing photos, logo, and copy before layout works starts.
- Weeks 3 till 4: Development of core pages and catalogue. CSS styling and responsive design pass.
- Week 5: Testing across devices. Form integration and testing – setting up Form spree (or equivalent) and testing that submission arrive. Cross-browser and device – checking the site in at least two browsers and mobile/tablet/desktop widths. Accessibility check – alt text, color contrasts, keyboard and navigation.
- Week 6: Launch, aligned with the subject's submission dates. Deployment – publishing to GitHub Pages/Netlify and confirming all links/images work on the live URL, not just locally.
- Week 7: Deployment and final proofreading- – a pass for typos, broken links, and consistency before submission.

Budget:

- Domain registration (. co.za): R150/year.
- Logo design/refinement (if someone outsourced rather than DIY): R500 to R1500.

- Stock or product photography (if not using your own phone camera): R0 (DIY) or R1000 + (professional).

Recurring costs:

- Web hosting: - R900/year (or R0 if using GitHub Pages/Netlify's free tier)
- SSL certificate: usually bundled free with modern hosts

(Netlify/GitHub Pages included this automatically) – worth naming explicitly since its real requirement, not just an add-on.

- Domain renewal: R150/year, recurring.

Tools and services:

- Form handling (Form spree free tier covers small volumes; paid tier - $10/month if the store outgrows the free submission limit) Google Workspace or similar for a professional email address (revivecothrift@gmail.com) instead of a personal email Gmail: - R100-R150/month per mailbox.

Ongoing maintenance:

- General site updates/content changes: -R400-R500/month (already in your draft-worth specifying what this covers: swapping product photos, updates stock, seasonal promotions).
- Minor bug fixes/technical support: build in a rough hourly rate or flat monthly allowance if this is meant to look like a real freelance/smallbusiness quote.

Major Changes made to the website:

Structure and Pages:

- Re-structured pages: Home.html, About page.html, Contact page.html and Location page.html

- Fixed broken page navigation filename mismatches.
- Fixed the About page's empty navigation menu.
- Made the logo clickable back to Home page instantly, and visually responding when already on the homepage.
- Standardized image folder casing (Images/) across all pages so the links don't break on case-sensitive hosting.
- Fixed a trailing-space bug in an image path that would have broken the logo.

Styling:

- Converted the entire site from inline styles to one shared external style.css file.
- Added responsive breakpoints (768px/480px) also nav stacks, cards go full-width, buttons stack on mobile. Full visual redesign: bold, stacked headline hero (Bedas Neue font) in forest green/mustard, category ticker strip, tagged products cards ("New In"/" Rare Find"). Added alternating image + text "spilt" sections (image left/right alternating) which is used for "Our Story," "Visit Us," and "Get in Touch" on the home page.
- Added a matching split section ("Behind the Racks") near the end of the About page.
- Increased logo size (60px to 130px).
- Removed the green background from the logo and made it transparent

Functionality:

- Added script.js with a working “Use My Location for Directions” button.
- We added a phone number to contact the Contact form (alongside name, email, subject, message).
- Added a two-photo gallery (“Find Us in Store) to the Contact page.

Major Changes made to the website: Part 3 (Final POE)

Part 3 turned the styled site from Part 2 into a fully working, search-engine-optimised website. JavaScript was added for the gallery, catalogue search, validation and form sending, every page was given SEO metadata, and the finished site was published online.

Live website: https://revive-thrit-co.netlify.app/

Response to Part 2 feedback:

Part 2 was marked 94 / 100. The lecturer’s comment on the change log (Knowledge criterion, 7 / 10) was:

> *“Adequate updates or changes made based on feedback. Changelog is detailed but could be improved.”*

- The change log in the README of the GitHub repository was rewritten so that every assignment part has its own dated entry, split into Added, Changed, Fixed and Removed.
- Each line now names the file that changed (for example *gallery page.html*, *script.js*, *style.css*) so every edit can be traced.
- A section recording this feedback and the correction made for it was added, together with a References section.
- The README file names and tables were corrected so they match the real project files.

Functionality (JavaScript):

- **Gallery page with lightbox and slideshow** (gallery page.html): all 13 catalogue photos in a responsive grid. Clicking a photo opens it full-size, and the previous / next buttons, the left and right arrow keys, or a swipe on a touch screen move through the pictures. The slideshow wraps around, shows a caption and an “n / total” counter, and closes with the × button, a click outside the image, or Escape.
- **Catalogue search and category filter** (home page): 13 items in 7 categories. The keyword search and the category buttons work together, a live result count updates as the user types, and an empty-state message links to the enquiry page when nothing matches.
- **Live date and time** in the footer of every page, refreshed every second.
-

FAQ accordion on the contact page: one answer open at a time with an animated height change.

- Hover and click transitions on buttons and product cards.

Forms:

- Two HTML forms: the **contact form** (name, email, phone, subject, message) and the **enquiry form** (name, email, enquiry-type drop-down, item or category, message).
- **JavaScript validation** with inline error messages: name of at least 2 characters, a correctly formatted email address, an optional South African phone number, a subject of at least 3 characters, a message of at least 10 characters, and a chosen enquiry type and item on the enquiry form.
- Forms are sent in the background with *fetch()* to **Netlify Forms**, so the page never reloads. The button shows a "Sending..." state, then a green confirmation or a red error message appears in place. A 10-second timeout and a hidden honeypot field protect against failed requests and spam bots.
- Every submission is stored in the Netlify dashboard and emailed to the site owner as a notification, so no email address appears in the public code.
- A **dynamic response** on the enquiry page is tailored to the enquiry type (availability, sizing, custom request or bulk order).
- Both forms were tested on the live site and the submissions were received.

Maps:

- A **Google Map** is embedded on the contact page using the iframe code from Google Maps, centred on Braamfontein, Johannesburg.
- The location page keeps its interactive **Leaflet map** with a marker and popup.

Search engine optimisation (SEO):

- Every page has its own keyword-led title, meta description, keywords, author, robots and canonical tags.
- Open Graph and Twitter card tags control how each page looks when a link is shared.
- JSON-LD structured data (*ClothingStore*) on the home page describes the store, its address and its opening hours for search engines.
- Descriptive alt text on every image, one main heading per page and semantic HTML5 elements.
- *robots.txt* and *sitemap.xml* list the site and all six pages.

Hosting, structure and documentation:

- The website is deployed for free on **Netlify**: https://revive-thrit-co.netlify.app/
- The home page was renamed from *Home.html* to *index.html* so that Netlify serves it as the front page, and the navigation links on every page now match the real file names.
- A **Gallery** link was added to the navigation bar on every page.
- The site now has six pages: index.html, about page.html, gallery page.html, location page.html, enquiry page.html and contact page.html.
- All changes are recorded in the change log in the README of the GitHub repository, which also lists the references used.

Final website against the proposal:

The table shows how each part of the original proposal turned out in the finished website.

Proposed	Status	Final website
Homepage with a brief store story and an About link	**Done**	Our Story section on index.html with a link to the About page
Shop / catalogue browsable by category	**Done**	Catalogue with search and category filters: tees, denim, hoodies, knitwear, caps, jewellery, footwear
Location and hours page with an embedded map	**Done**	Leaflet map on the location page and a Google Map on the contact page
“NEW IN” tags on stock	**Done**	“New In” and “Rare Find” tags on every catalogue card
Logo returns the user home	**Done**	The logo links to index.html on every page
Contact page with email options	**Done**	Contact form and enquiry form, with each message emailed to the store through Netlify Forms
Instagram feed to show new stock	**Changed**	Replaced by a gallery page with a lightbox slideshow of the stock
WhatsApp contact option	**Not added**	Customers contact the store through the two forms
HTML, CSS and JavaScript	**Done**	Hand-written HTML5, one external stylesheet and one JavaScript file
Meta description tags per page	**Done**	Full SEO metadata on all six pages
Git and GitHub for version control	**Done**	Project and change log kept in a GitHub repository

Form handling with Formspree or similar	**Changed**	Netlify Forms, which needs no separate service and keeps the email address out of the code
Hosting on GitHub Pages or Netlify	**Done**	Hosted on Netlify
Own .co.za domain	**Not bought**	The free netlify.app address is used for this submission. The domain stays in the budget for a real launch
Minified CSS and JavaScript	**Not applied**	Files are left readable for marking

References:

Revive Thrift Co. is a fictional business. Its design direction was loosely informed by general observation of Braamfontein's second-hand clothing retail scene, including Thrift Vintage Clothes, a since-closed local store, used here only as inspiration and not as a real-world subject of this proposal.

Google (n.d.) *Embed a map*. Google Maps Platform, Maps Embed API. [online] Available at:< https://support.google.com/maps/answer/144361> [Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Google (n.d.) *Meta tags and attributes that Google supports*. Google Search Central. [online] Available at: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/special-tags>[Accessed:30 October 2026].

Google Fonts (n.d.) *Bebas Neue*. [online] Available at: <https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Bebas+Neue> [Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Leaflet (n.d.) *Leaflet: an open-source JavaScript library for interactive maps*. [online] Available at: <https://leafletjs.com/ >[Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Mozilla Developer Network (n.d.) *Date.prototype.toLocaleString()*. [online] Available at:<https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/JavaScript/Reference/Global_Objects/Date/toLocaleString>[Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Mozilla Developer Network (n.d.) *setInterval() global function*. [online] Available at:<https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/API/Window/setInterval>[Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Netlify (n.d.) *Add a new project*. Netlify Docs. [online] Available at:<https://docs.netlify.com/manage/projects/add-new-project/> [Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Netlify (n.d.) *Forms setup*. Netlify Docs. [online] Available at:<https://docs.netlify.com/manage/forms/setup/>[Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Open Graph protocol (n.d.) *The Open Graph protocol*. [online] Available at: <https://ogp.me/>[Accessed: 30 October 2026].

Schema.org (n.d.) *ClothingStore*. [online] Available at:<https://schema.org/ClothingStore >[Accessed: 30 October 2026].

W3Schools (n.d.) *How TO: Lightbox*. [online] Available at:< https://www.w3schools.com/howto/howto_js_lightbox.asp> [Accessed: 30 October 2026].

W3Schools (n.d.) *JavaScript Form Validation*. Available at:< https://www.w3schools.com/js/js_validation.asp> [Accessed: 30 October 2026].